

Word family: ****tie / ties / tied / tying****

****Base word:**** tie

****Part of speech:**** mainly ****verb**** and ****noun****

****Related forms:****

* ****tie**** (v.) — 綁；繫；連結；使相關；打成平手；限制

* ****tie**** (n.) — 領帶；繩結；聯繫；關係；平局

* ****tied**** (adj./participle) — 被綁住的；相連的；受限制的；平手的

* ****tying**** (gerund/participle) — 綁；連結

* ****tie-in**** (n.) — 關聯；配套 / 聯動內容

* ****tie-up**** (n.) — 合作關係；延誤 / 堵塞 (視語境)

****Useful expressions / extensions:****

* ****tie something****

* ****tie your shoes****

* ****tie A to B****

* ****be tied to****

* ****tie something together****

* ****tie for first place****

* ****a tie****

* ****family ties****

* ****business ties****

* ****close ties****

* ****cut / strengthen ties****

* ****tie in with****

* ****tie up****

* ****tie someone down****

* ****tie up loose ends****

* ****railroad tie****

* ****neck tie / tie****

* ****bow tie****

Meaning in this passage

> When diligent workers realise that their performance is being ****tied to colleagues**** who are less committed, motivation begins to decline.

Here, ****tied to**** means:

****linked or connected to something in such a way that one affects or depends on the other — 與.....掛鉤；與.....連結；受.....影響****

The diligent workers' results are not being judged completely independently. Their performance or outcome is connected to that of less committed colleagues.

****中文翻譯：****

當勤奮的員工意識到自己的表現竟然****與投入程度較低的同事掛鉤 / 綁在一起****時，他們的動力便開始下降。

So here:

****be tied to X = 與 X 有直接關聯，以致 X 的狀況會影響自己****

1. ****tie something (綁；繫) — 綁；繫****

The core literal verb sense.

Practice 1

> He ****tied the box with string****.

他用繩把箱子****綁好****。

Practice 2

> She ****tied her hair back****.

她把頭髮****紮到後面****。

Practice 3

> ****Tie the bag**** securely.

把袋子****綁緊****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie = 用繩、帶或類似物件把東西固定、連接或束起來****

2. ****tie your shoes / shoelaces — 綁鞋帶****

Practice 1

> I stopped to **tie my shoelaces**.

我停下來**綁鞋帶**。

Practice 2

> Can you **tie your shoes** by yourself?

你可以自己**綁鞋帶**嗎？

MCQ-ready definition:

tie your shoelaces = 把鞋帶打結固定

3. **tie a knot — 打結**

Practice 1

> **Tie a knot** at the end of the rope.

在繩尾**打一個結**。

Practice 2

> He **tied a tight knot**.

他**打了一個很緊的結**。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie a knot = 把繩等纏繞並固定成結

4. **tie A to B (把 A 綁在 B 上) — 把.....繫在.....**

Literal construction.

Practice 1

> She **tied the bicycle to the fence**.

她把單車**綁在圍欄上**。

Practice 2

> The boat was ****tied to the dock****.

小艇被****繫在碼頭旁****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie A to B = 用繩等把 A 固定在 B 上****

5. ****tie A to B (figurative : 把兩者連結) — 把 A 與 B 掛鈎 / 連結****

This is the key figurative extension behind your passage.

Practice 1

> The company ****tied bonuses to performance****.

公司把獎金****與工作表現掛鈎****。

Practice 2

> Pay should not always be ****tied directly to sales figures****.

薪酬不應總是直接****與銷售數字掛鈎****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie A to B = 令 A 與 B 直接相關、相互依賴或由 B 決定****

6. ****be tied to — 與.....掛鈎 ; 與.....密切相關****

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Their performance was ****tied to their colleagues' performance****.

他們的表現被****與同事的表現掛鈎****。

Practice 2

> Promotion is partly ****tied to performance****.

晉升部分****與工作表現掛鈎****。

Practice 3

> The final result is ****tied to how well the whole team performs****.

最終結果****取決於 / 與整個團隊的表現密切相關****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be tied to X = 與 X 有直接關聯，因此受 X 影響或由 X 部分決定****

7. ****tie something to a condition / requirement — 把某事與條件掛鉤****

Practice 1

> Funding was ****tied to specific conditions****.

資金****與特定條件掛鉤****。

Practice 2

> The reward is ****tied to measurable results****.

獎勵****與可量度成果掛鉤****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie X to a condition = 只有符合某條件，X 才會發生或獲得****

8. ****tie something together — 把不同部分連結起來****

Literal or figurative.

Practice 1

> This final paragraph ****ties the argument together****.

這個最後段落把整個論點****串連起來****。

Practice 2

> A shared objective can ****tie the team together****.

共同目標可以把團隊****凝聚在一起****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie X together = 把不同部分連成一個完整、連貫或團結的整體****

9. ****tie (noun : 領帶) — 領帶****

A major distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> He wore a blue ****tie****.

他戴了一條藍色****領帶****。

Practice 2

> You don't need to wear a ****tie**** to the meeting.

你開會不需要戴****領帶****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie = 繞在衣領下並垂在胸前的正式服飾****

10. ****bow tie — 煲呔 ; 蝴蝶領結****

Practice 1

> He wore a black ****bow tie****.

他戴了一個黑色****煲呔****。

Practice 2

> The waiter was wearing a ****bow tie****.

侍應戴着****蝴蝶領結****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****bow tie = 打成蝴蝶結形狀的領結****

11. ****tie (noun : 關係 ; 聯繫) — 關係 ; 聯繫****

A major figurative noun sense.

Practice 1

> The two companies have close **ties**.

兩間公司有密切的**關係**。

Practice 2

> She maintains strong **ties** with her former colleagues.

她和以前的同事保持緊密**聯繫**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ties = 人、組織或地方之間持續存在的關係或聯繫

12. **family ties — 家庭聯繫；親情關係**

Practice 1

> Strong **family ties** are important to him.

緊密的**家庭關係**對他很重要。

Practice 2

> She returned home because of **family ties**.

她因為**家庭聯繫**而回到家鄉。

MCQ-ready definition:

family ties = 家庭成員之間的關係、聯繫和責任

13. **business / professional ties — 商業 / 專業聯繫**

Practice 1

> The firms developed closer **business ties**.

兩間公司建立了更緊密的**商業聯繫**。

Practice 2

> He has strong **professional ties** with the industry.

他和該行業有緊密的**專業聯繫**。

MCQ-ready definition:

business/professional ties = 公司或專業人士之間持續的合作或聯繫

14. **diplomatic / economic ties** — 外交 / 經濟關係

Practice 1

> The two countries strengthened economic **ties**.

兩國加強了**經濟聯繫**。

Practice 2

> They restored diplomatic **ties**.

雙方恢復了**外交關係**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ties = 國家、政府或經濟體之間的正式關係

15. **cut / break ties with** — 與.....斷絕關係

Practice 1

> The company **cut ties** with the supplier.

公司與供應商**中止合作關係**。

Practice 2

> He decided to **break ties** with the organisation.

他決定與該組織**斷絕關係**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****cut/break ties with X = 終止與 X 的關係或聯繫****

16. ****strengthen ties — 加強關係****

Practice 1

> The project helped ****strengthen ties between the departments****.

這個項目有助****加強部門之間的聯繫****。

Practice 2

> The visit was intended to ****strengthen business ties****.

這次訪問旨在****加強商業關係****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****strengthen ties = 令已有的關係變得更緊密****

17. ****tie (比賽：平手) — 平局；平手****

A genuinely distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> The match ended in a ****tie****.

比賽以****平局****結束。

Practice 2

> There was a ****tie for first place****.

第一名出現****平手****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a tie = 比賽或競爭中雙方取得相同分數或結果****

****BrE note:**** In many sports, ****draw**** is more common in British English.

18. **tie (verb : 打成平手) — 打和 ; 平手**

Practice 1

> The two teams **tied 2–2**.

兩隊以二比二**打成平手**。

Practice 2

> She **tied for first place**.

她**並列第一**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie = 在比賽、排名或投票中取得與另一方相同結果****

19. **tie for first / second place — 並列第一 / 第二**

Practice 1

> Two candidates **tied for first place**.

兩名參賽者**並列第一**。

Practice 2

> The teams are currently **tied for second**.

兩隊目前**並列第二**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie for X place = 兩個或以上參賽者取得相同排名****

20. **tie (體育賽事的一場對賽) — 對賽 ; 淘汰賽組合**

Especially BrE, particularly football.

Practice 1

> The cup **tie** will be played on Saturday.

這場盃賽**對賽**會在星期六舉行。

Practice 2

> They won the **tie** over two matches.

他們在兩回合**對賽**中勝出。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie = BrE sports: 錦標賽或淘汰賽中的一組對賽

21. **tie up something (綁牢) — 綁好 ; 繫好**

Practice 1

> **Tie up the boat** before leaving.

離開前把船**繫好**。

Practice 2

> The boxes were **tied up with string**.

箱子用繩**綁好**了。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie up X = 把 X 用繩等綁牢

22. **tie someone up (綁住某人) — 把某人綁住**

Practice 1

> The robber **tied the guard up**.

劫匪把保安員**綁了起來**。

Practice 2

> His hands were **tied up**.

他的雙手被**綁住**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie someone up = 用繩等限制某人的身體活動****

23. ****be tied up (忙得不可開交) — 忙着；抽不開身****

A very common figurative phrasal use.

Practice 1

> I'm ****tied up in meetings**** all afternoon.

我整個下午都****忙着開會，抽不開身****。

Practice 2

> She's ****tied up at the moment****.

她現在****忙得走不開****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be tied up = 因某件工作佔用了時間而暫時無法做其他事情****

24. ****tie up resources / money — 佔用資源 / 資金****

Practice 1

> The project ****ties up too much capital****.

這個項目****佔用了太多資金****。

Practice 2

> The delay ****tied up staff for several hours****.

延誤****佔用了員工數小時****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie up resources = 令資源暫時被某用途佔用，不能用於其他事情****

25. ****tie up loose ends — 處理收尾細節****

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> We need to **tie up a few loose ends** before the launch.

推出前，我們還要**處理幾項收尾細節**。

Practice 2

> She spent the afternoon **tying up loose ends**.

她整個下午都在**把未完成的小事處理好**。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie up loose ends = 把剩下未處理的小問題或細節全部完成

26. **tie in with — 與.....相符 / 相關 / 配合**

Practice 1

> The findings **tie in with** earlier research.

研究結果**與較早的研究相符**。

Practice 2

> This idea **ties in with** our main objective.

這個想法**與我們的主要目標相配合**。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie in with X = 與 X 有關聯、相符或互相配合

27. **tie-in (關聯；配套內容) — 聯動；配套項目**

Practice 1

> The book was released as a film **tie-in**.

這本書作為電影的**配套聯動出版物**推出。

Practice 2

> The campaign included several promotional **tie-ins**.

宣傳活動包括數項**聯動推廣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie-in = 與另一產品、活動或作品刻意建立的商業或內容關聯

28. **tie someone down** — 束縛；限制自由

Literal or figurative.

Practice 1

> He doesn't want a job that **ties him down**.

他不要一份會**束縛自己自由**的工作。

Practice 2

> Family responsibilities can **tie people down**.

家庭責任有時會**限制一個人的自由安排**。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie someone down = 限制某人的自由，使其因責任或承諾不能隨意行動

29. **be tied down by** — 被……束縛

Practice 1

> She didn't want to be **tied down by unnecessary commitments**.

她不想被不必要的承諾**束縛**。

Practice 2

> Small businesses can be **tied down by excessive paperwork**.

小型企業可能被過多文書工作**拖住 / 束縛**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be tied down by X = 因 X 而受到限制，難以自由行動或改變****

30. ****tied accommodation / tied house — 與工作掛鈎的住房 / 特許酒吧****

Established BrE uses.

Practice 1

> The job comes with ****tied accommodation****.

這份工作附帶****與職位掛鈎的住宿****。

Practice 2

> Traditionally, a ****tied house**** sold beer supplied by a particular brewery.

傳統上，****特許酒吧****會出售指定酒廠供應的啤酒。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tied = 受某份工作、供應商或商業安排限制或依附的****

31. ****railroad tie — 鐵路枕木****

Mainly AmE; BrE usually ****railway sleeper****.

Practice 1

> The rails rest on wooden ****railroad ties****.

鐵軌鋪在木製****枕木****上。

Practice 2

> Several old ****ties**** needed replacing.

幾根舊****枕木****需要更換。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****railroad tie = AmE: 橫放在鐵軌下面、用來支撐和固定鐵軌的構件****

32. **structural tie** — 拉結件；連接件

A construction/engineering sense.

Practice 1

> Metal **ties** connect the two walls.

金屬**拉結件**把兩面牆連接起來。

Practice 2

> The structure uses steel **ties** for support.

結構使用鋼製**連接件**加強支撐。

MCQ-ready definition:

tie = 建築或工程中用來把不同部分連接、固定或拉住的構件

Important distinction 1: **tie** vs **bind**

tie

usually use string/rope, or figuratively link things.

bind

fasten tightly or impose a stronger obligation.

> tie the bag

> 綁好袋

> be legally bound by a contract

> 受合約法律約束

Bind often sounds stronger or more formal in abstract contexts.

Important distinction 2: **tie** vs **attach**

attach

join one object to another.

tie

specifically suggests fastening with string/rope, or figuratively linking.

> attach a file to an email

> 把檔案附加到電郵

> tie a boat to the dock

> 把船繫在碼頭

Important distinction 3: **be tied to vs be related to**

related to

general connection.

tied to

usually suggests a **closer, more consequential dependency**.

> Stress is related to performance.

> 壓力與表現有關。

> Bonuses are tied to performance.

> 獎金**與表現掛鉤**。

The second implies one may directly determine the other.

Important distinction 4: **be tied to vs depend on**

depend on

X is necessary or determines the outcome.

be tied to

X and Y are linked, often by a rule, system, or shared outcome.

> Success depends on teamwork.

> 成功取決於團隊合作。

> Pay is tied to performance.

> 薪酬與表現掛鈎。

Important distinction 5: **tie together vs connect**

connect

neutral.

tie together

often emphasizes bringing separate ideas/parts into one coherent whole.

> This paragraph ties the argument together.

> 這段把論點**串連成完整整體**。

Important distinction 6: **tie noun = relationship vs connection**

connection

any link.

tie

often a continuing social, family, economic, or institutional relationship.

> family ties

> 家庭關係

> internet connection

> 網絡連線

Not interchangeable everywhere.

Important distinction 7: **tie vs draw in sports**

tie

especially common in AmE.

draw

especially common in BrE for a game ending level.

> The match ended in a draw.

> 比賽打和。

> The game ended in a tie.

> 比賽打成平手。

Important distinction 8: **tie for first**

This does not mean the competitors literally tie each other together.

It means:

兩人 / 多人取得相同成績，因此並列某個排名

Important distinction 9: **be tied up literal vs figurative**

Literal:

> His hands were tied up.

> 他的手被綁住。

Figurative:

> I'm tied up all afternoon.

> 我整個下午都**忙得抽不開身**。

Context is crucial.

Important distinction 10: **tie up resources**

This means resources are:

occupied and temporarily unavailable

not physically tied.

- > capital tied up in property
- > 資金被物業**佔住**

Important distinction 11: **tie someone down**

This is stronger than merely **keep someone busy**.

It often suggests:

long-term responsibility or commitment reducing freedom

Important distinction 12: **tie in with**

Do not confuse:

- > **tie X to Y**
- > 把 X 與 Y 掛鈎

with:

- > **X ties in with Y**
- > X 與 Y **相符 / 配合**

Different grammar and nuance.

Important distinction 13: **ties plural**

For relationships, plural **ties** is much more common:

- > family ties
- > economic ties
- > professional ties

Singular **tie** can occur:

- > a close tie between the two organisations

but plural is especially common for broad relationships.

Important distinction 14: ****tied in your passage****

The metaphor is especially important:

Literal:

two objects are physically tied together, so one cannot move independently.

Figurative:

one employee's performance is linked to colleagues, so their outcome is ****not independent****.

That is exactly why diligent workers become frustrated.

Family-extension note

****Tie**** has several major modern semantic branches:

1. ****physical fastening****

- * tie a knot

- * tie A to B

2. ****figurative linking/dependence****

- * be tied to performance

- * tie rewards to results

3. ****clothing****

- * tie

- * bow tie

4. ****relationships****

- * family ties

- * business ties

- * cut ties

5. ****equal results****

- * a tie
- * tie for first

6. **sports event**

- * cup tie

7. **occupation/restriction**

- * tied up
- * tie someone down
- * money tied up

8. **coherence/compatibility**

- * tie together
- * tie in with

9. **fixed idioms**

- * tie up loose ends

10. **technical objects**

- * railroad tie
- * structural tie

For your passage, the exact branch is:

be tied to = be closely linked so that one person's outcome is affected by another person's performance

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
tie (verb)	綁；繫	fastening	
tie a knot	打結	knot	
tie A to B	把 A 綁到 B	physical connection	
tie A to B (figurative)	把 A 與 B 掛鉤	dependency	
be tied to	與.....掛鉤 / 相連	linked outcome	
tie together	串連 / 凝聚	unify	
tie (clothing)	領帶	clothing	
bow tie	煲呔 / 蝴蝶領結	clothing	

ties (relationships)	關係；聯繫	social/institutional link	
family ties	家庭聯繫	family	
business ties	商業關係	business	
cut ties	斷絕關係	end relationship	
strengthen ties	加強關係	closer relationship	
tie (score)	平局；平手	equal result	
tie for first	並列第一	equal ranking	
tie (sports event)	一場淘汰賽對賽	BrE sports	
tie up	綁牢	physical	
be tied up	忙得抽不開身	occupied	
tie up resources	佔用資源	unavailable resources	
tie up loose ends	處理收尾細節	completion	
tie in with	與.....相符 / 配合	compatibility	
tie-in	聯動 / 配套	commercial/content link	
tie someone down	束縛某人	restrict freedom	
railroad tie	鐵路枕木	AmE railway	
structural tie	拉結件；連接件	engineering	

For your original sentence

> When diligent workers realise that their performance is being ****tied to colleagues**** who are less committed, motivation begins to decline.

Here:

****tied to colleagues** = 自己的成果、評價或成績並非完全由自己控制，而是與其他組員的表現綁在一起，所以其他人的低投入也會拖低自己的整體結果**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當勤奮的員工意識到自己的表現竟然****與投入程度較低的同事掛鉤****時，他們的動力便開始下降。

The cleanest contrast is:

> ****related to**** = 有關聯

> ****linked to**** = 有連結

> ****dependent on**** = 取決於

> ****tied to**** = ****被緊密掛鉤，以致不能完全獨立於另一方的結果****

That last sense is exactly what makes ****tied to**** so effective in this teamwork paragraph.